

viewing HD content that is also 16:9. LGs 237WA, is a 23-inch LCD monitor and a neat one at that. Thanks to the cable connect and remote control bundled, it can be used as a TV too. It's priced at Rs. 17,300. Even ViewSonic had a model, called the VX2433WM that is priced at Rs. 18,000 and has a 16:9 aspect ratio, but no TV connect – just D-Sub, DVI and HDMI.

So far, I didn't have any luck with finding Dell monitors, but the third shop I sauntered into informed me he could "arrange" for Dell, though it would take three days to deliver. He also promised delivery to my doorstep for a "mere" 150 bucks more. I enquired about the prices. The Ultrasharp 2209WA was available for Rs. 20,000 and this 22-inch panel is an IPS one, making it suitable for my work. I enquired about the bigger displays, the new Dell U2410 (H-IPS panel), was priced at Rs. 38,000, while the superbly large Dell 2709W (S-PVA panel) was priced at an astronomical Rs. 49,000. It had been my secret dream to own this last monitor – 1920 x 1200 pixel resolution, an amazing panel for movies and games and all the connects necessary, plus a wide colour gamut. But the price broke my heart.

Quietly I enquired about any other monitors and was told that NEC displays were also available, and their 24-inch IPS-panel MultiSync 2490WUXi2 was available for a whopping 75,000 bucks – might as well buy that Ferrari while I'm at it. I settled for the Dell 2209WA and was told that it would be delivered to my doorstep provided I pay 25 per cent of the dough up front which I did. Sadly, when it came high-end panels, there's very little choice for discerning buyers. Talk about cheaper LCDs and you'll have a wagonload of choices.

